



Event Management Plan

DRAFT

Event: CPPP The Whale Street

Dates: Friday 17th ,Saturday
18th of July 2026.

Prepared by: Frank Commins

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EVENT GENERAL

INTRODUCTION

This Event Management Plan (EMP) establishes the details for a street spectacle titled **The Whale Street** to be held on Friday 17th Saturday 18th July 2026 and is a key document in the planning and management of the event. It should be used as a reference tool for all stakeholders, statutory agencies and is circulated to all parties in advance for clarification and agreement.

This EMP is subject to amendments and updates during the planning of the event, up to and including event day, although the latter should be minor. Where possible all changes will be documented and circulated to all however all stakeholders should note the REV version of the EMP for the most up to date version of the EMP.

REVISION

This is a REVISION of the Event Management Plan for GIAF The Whale Streetstreet spectacle

See Previous versions below:

REVISION	DATE	AUTHOR
Draft	16 th April 2026	Frank Commins

EVENT ORGANISERS

The organiser of this event is Galway International Arts Festival

Their details are as follows:

ADDRESS	KEY CONTACTS	CONTACT DETAILS
Blackbox,Dyke Rd,Galway	Adam Fitzsimons	Ph: (087)9799214

APPOINTED ROLE

For this event, Adam Fitzsimons is fulfilling the role of event organiser on behalf of Galway International Arts Festival and will provide the Event Manager at the event.

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COMPONENTS OF THE PLAN

This EMP has been prepared in accordance with appropriate Legislation, Regulations, Guidelines, Codes of Practices and Bye Laws and includes the following fundamental components:

- Event Information
- Medical and stewarding information
- Emergency and contingency plans
- Crowd safety and management information

SENSITIVE INFORMATION

Event arrangements may involve sensitive and/or confidential information, and as such will not be disclosed to unauthorised persons or the general public. Where deemed necessary certain information has been omitted from this EMP, for safety and security reasons, however all key personnel and necessary persons will be briefed in person.

CONSULTATIONS

Throughout the planning of this event consultations are ongoing between Galway City Council and Adam Fitzsimons and Event Control and the following:

- Galway City Council
- An Garda Síochána
- Civil Defence
- Fire Services
- HSE Emergency Planning

MEETINGS

All planning for this event is managed by Adam Fitzsimons in addition to ongoing planning, other meetings and site visits will occur in the planning of this event. Site visits still need to take place to ensure adequate planning takes place.

EVENT MANAGEMENT

There will be a full Event Management team in place for this event. Key roles have been identified and key personnel have been appointed to those roles. All key personnel are experienced in their respective roles and will be supported in the performance of their duties and responsibilities by their colleagues on the Event Management Team.

The Event Management Team will coordinate all event arrangements in consultation with Steward at the event. They will work closely with volunteers, stewards and An Garda Síochána at the event. The Event Management Team will oversee the organising of

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suitable stewards and security, together with all other necessary personnel, on duties both in and around the event space. The Event Management Team will ensure that an adequate number of staff is deployed for the event.

The Event Management Team will be in overall control of the event unless a Major Emergency is declared (as per the Framework of Emergency Management definition), at which time, the most applicable primary response agency (PRA), (An Garda Síochána, HSE or Local Authority) will take control of the emergency. In this case the Event Management Team will put at the disposal of the Emergency Controller all resources present and available to aid in dealing with the emergency. See further details in the Emergency Procedures section below.

All personnel will be given a briefing in advance of the event outlining their role, duties and responsibilities. It is then the responsibility of key Event Management Personnel to brief their respective teams.

EVENT DETAILS

Event: The Whale Street

Dates: Friday 17th and Saturday 18th 2026.

Start Time: Friday @21.30 and Saturday @ 21:30

Finish Times: Friday @22.45 and Saturday @ 22:45

Estimated Duration: 75 minutes.

Projected Audience: 10,000 people

1.1 The Event Route is as follows:

The company will have set up base at Nimmo's Pier for assembly and dressing room. They will travel from there under escort along Merchants Rd to arrive in Eyre Square to the entrance of Eyre Square shopping centre. They leave Eyre Square on to Shop street, Mainguard Street, Bridge Street, Dominick Street, and finish outside Monroe's and Fairhill Rd Lower turning left onto Fr Griffin Road and finishing at a performance space in Spanish Arch.

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ATTENDEE PROFILE

The attendees will be mixed, with families and individuals.

EXPECTED WEATHER

This event will be subject to the weather conditions on the evening. Depending on the conditions, the event procession will respond accordingly.

In the event of inclement weather, following consultations with Met Eireann the event will not take place.

Weather conditions include wind monitoring with hand held anemometer will be closely monitored before and during the event.

STEWARDING

The event stewarding and security for the event will be provided by C2 Security . All personnel will receive full and thorough briefing on event days.

TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT

A traffic management plan will be required for this event. Galway City Council have agreed to support and supply vehicles to satisfy the Hostile Vehicles Mitigation (HVM) aspect of the plan, it is proposed that these vehicles be used to close the following roads.

These vehicles will be attended at all times and can be moved quickly upon request from Control room in the event of emergency vehicles movement.

The proposal is that vehicles will be deployed at the below locations

Vehicle blocks:

- At Eyre Square (Eyre Square Shopping Centre), the taxi rank, and the top of Eyre Square East/Prospect Hill.
- Pedestrian Area covered by existing vehicle mitigation barriers, this will be lowered as the parade approaches and raised after it passes.
- At Eglinton Street at the intersection with Wood Quay & Mary Street and Market Street.
- The corner of Mill St and Dominick St

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- At St Patrick's School to prevent vehicles entering from one way Street.
- At the junction at Father Griffin Road and Fairhill Rd Upper.
- At the Dail Bar closing of entrance to Cross Street.
- Exit from Raven Terrace carpark onto Fairhill Rd Upper.
- Leonardo's Car Park rear exit we will be requested to close for the duration.
- Signage will be placed on streets seven days prior to event to inform drivers of no parking during event times. It will be assessed if vehicles need to be removed on the day.
- Fr Griffin Road at Tesco.
- The old Palas cinema and junction of Merchants Rd lower.

There is a total of eleven locations requiring HVM closures.

Additional Measures

Dominick Street Upper will be closed for outdoor dining which we will commence at an earlier time of 3pm on the Saturday.

Ravens Terrace will be closed for outdoor dining which we will commence at an earlier time of 3pm on the Saturday.

This series of road closures will be put into place prior and during the event at timing deemed necessary by event control and An Gardaí, the purpose of this is for the safety and enjoyment for the public and participants.

DRAWINGS

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Drawings for this event are on-going through the planning stages and included appendix follows:

TITLE	SCALE
Site Plan	Not to scale

PUBLIC INFORMATION

All event information will be available on local newspapers in the weeks leading up to the event and in GIAF programmes, social media and <https://www.giaf.ie>

LOST & FOUND

Any items found will be handed in to the local event manager who will in turn hand it to An Garda Síochána at the end of the event. Details of any / all lost items will be taken and passed to An Garda Síochána.

EVENT MANAGEMENT TEAM ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

EVENT MANAGEMENT TEAM

Each role on the Event Management Team has specific responsibilities and duties. The Team will work collaboratively in relation to every element of the effective safe management of the event.

The main Event Management Team roles for this event are as follows:

Name	Role	Company	Contact
GIAF	Promotor	GIAF	091 509700
Adam Fitzsimons	Event Manager	GIAF	087 9799214
Frank Commings	Event control	Freelance	087 6479231
Garda Darragh Browne	Garda on duty	An Garda Síochána	
Declan Gibbons	Safety officer	GIAF	086 8359753
Brendan Qualter Kieran connell	Medical Co-ordinators	Civil defence	(+353) 87 738 7333 (+353) 87 382 7920

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Tom o Connor	Chief steward	C2	087 6233227
Kieth Flynn	Security manager	C2	087 2661514
National Ambulance Services (NAS)	National Emergency Operation Centre		01 4633410
Emergency services	National Emergency Operation Centre	Garda/fire /ambulance	112 or 999

MANAGEMENT STRUCTURE

Event Controller

The Event Controller has overall control and responsibility of the event on event day, with the exception of during an emergency whereby the Emergency Controller may assume authority. This person should be of suitable competence and authority to manage the overall event and deal with all stakeholders involved. There may be a committee or group actually organising all the details of the event however it is the Event Controller that has ultimate primacy on all arrangements, and it is imperative that this person has the ability to carry out this role suitably. The main duties of the Event Controller include (this list is non-exhaustive);

- i. having overall responsibility for the management of the event;
- ii. being involved in and contributing to the planning meetings with the relevant authorities i.e.: An Garda Siochana, HSE, Local Authority etc.;
- iii. ensuring the provision of adequate personnel for the event;
- iv. remaining contactable, in relation to the event, before, during and after the event
- v. contributing to a post event meeting on the event.

It is important to note that this is not an honorary role, on the contrary, they have clear legal and moral responsibilities, and they are essentially accountable for the safe management of the event and the safety of all those involved. It is imperative that the persons appointed to these roles are competent for these roles specifically and if/where necessary external advice should be sought. It is also essential that these persons are adequately insured for the role which they carry out. Competency is defined as having the appropriate experience and knowledge appropriate to the nature of the work to be undertaken.

SAFETY OFFICER

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The Safety Officer has specific responsibility for the safety arrangements for the event. They will be involved during the planning phase for the event and will advise on all safety elements.

The appointed Safety Officer will be capable, competent and insured to perform their duties. They will work closely with the Event Controller to ensure that safety is a consideration in all-key decisions.

Specific responsibilities of the Safety Officer include, but are not limited to, the following:

- Fully comprehend the Event Management Plan
- Fully comprehend all relevant and impacting Codes of Practice, Regulations, Legislation, Guidance and best practice
- Ensuring that all safety arrangements, as per Event Management Plan and any relevant agreements are implemented as appropriate
- Preparing and delivering a structured and comprehensive briefing for relevant staff and stakeholders
- Maintain a monitoring brief during the event
- Monitoring crowd movements and build-ups
- Implementing any remedial actions in order to relieve or avoid undesirable issues during the event
- Ensuring effective reporting and recording arrangements are in place and communicated to staff in advance
- Assisting in an emergency situation as required
- Undertaking any reasonable duties as necessary to ensure the smooth running of the event
- Contributing to any and all Post Event Reviews and Post Event Reports with a particular focus on safety elements

MEDICAL COORDINATOR

The Medical Coordinator has overall responsibility for the medical provision and medical response to incidents on-site during the event. In relation to matters relating specifically to the medical well-being and safety of all at the event, the Medical Coordinator will work closely with the Event Management Team.

The appointed Medical Coordinator will be capable, competent and insured to perform their duties. They will have extensive experience as a medical professional and in positions of leadership within the medical environment and will bring to bear that experience at all times during this event.

Specific responsibilities of members of the Medical Coordinator include, but are not limited to, the following:

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- Being familiar with the Event Management Plan
- Being familiar with all relevant and impacting Codes of Practice, Legislation, Regulations, Guidance and best practice
- Ensuring that all medical arrangements, as per Medical Plan and Event Management Plan, and any relevant agreements are implemented as appropriate
- Ensure all Medical Provisions are on site and operational as agreed, prior to the event going live.
- Ensuring all medical personnel are on site and are fit for duty
- Ensuring an effective and efficient medical service
- Ensuring medical cover is provided during the agreed times
- Maintain a monitoring brief during the event
- Report any crowd movements and build-ups to event control
- Liaising with the Event Management Team in relation to any and all incidents, including any transportations off site to local medical facilities
- Implementing any remedial actions to relieve or avoid undesirable issues during the event.
- Reporting and recording any issues or potential issues encountered during the event
- Assisting in an emergency situation as required
- Undertaking any reasonable duties as necessary to ensure the smooth running of the event
- Contributing to any and all Post Event Reviews and Post Event Reports with a particular focus on safety elements

CHIEF STEWARD

The Chief Steward will be responsible for:

- Overall stewarding and security arrangements at the event
- Be competent to recognise critical crowd conditions, signs of crowd distress and crowd dynamics.
- Co-ordinating the duties of all stewards and security in conjunction with the Event Management Team.
- Preparing a Stewarding/Security plan, which will include, Personnel Details and Licences (where applicable) and deployment details.
- Ensuring that all stewards and security sign in on the morning of the event and details of same are returned to Event Control
- Ensuring that all stewards are adequately briefed and knowledgeable of all arrangements in advance of event going live
- Deploying stewards and security as per plan and as necessary to deal with situations as they arise.

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- Ensuring that stewards are observing key points where management is most needed
- Know the layout of the location, where facilities are located and being fully familiar with the means of escape and evacuation procedures in the event of an emergency
- Ensuring that all radios used for communication and loudspeakers are operational.
- Maintaining contact with and reporting directly to the Event Management Team.
- Assist the emergency services as required and/or as directed by the Event Management Team.

STEWARDS

Stewards will be responsible for:

- Ensuring that the public are safely accommodated within the viewing / circulation areas in a planned manner, so as to ensure the safety and comfort of all spectators at the event.
- Be aware of the Medical and Fire Safety arrangements.
- Be familiar with the Emergency Plan, Procedures and their part in its operation and specified duties to be undertaken
- Give immediate access to Gardaí and other emergency services in the event of an emergency
- Control and / or direct the public who are entering or leaving the area and help achieve an even flow of people as directed
- Be competent to recognise crowd densities, signs of crowd distress and crowd dynamics so as to help ensure safe dispersal of the public and ensure there is no overcrowding
- Be courteous and provide information to the public and give assistance if required
- Exercise proper management over the public
- When requested, assist at barriers and giving information to attendees approaching the event
- Ensure that emergency access routes and emergency egress routes are kept clear and free from obstruction at all times
- Prevent any climbing on fences and other structures; if in difficulty they should immediately contact their Chief Steward or a Garda
- Assist Gardaí with crowd management as requested
- Investigate promptly any disturbance or other reported incident
- Report immediately to Chief Steward or Garda, if any fire or other emergency comes to notice.

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- Be capable of recognising potential hazards and suspect packages and reporting such findings Chief Steward, if any damage likely to cause injury or danger to spectators comes to notice
- Assist lost persons as per procedure.

BRIEFINGS

Event briefings details are as follows:

TEAM	DATE	TIME
Event management teams	17/7/26	18.00
Security	17/7/26	18.30

In addition to the above these briefing will be repeated before each performance and cascade briefings will occur with individuals to ensure all stewards, security and volunteer personnel receive key information.

LICENCES, CODES OF PRACTISE, LEGISLATION, REGULATIONS & BY-LAWS

EVENT MANAGEMENT TEAM ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

LICENCES

This event does require a license and the normal planning requirements have been aheard too. Continues communication are been held with Galway City Council /An Gardai/HSE.

CODES OF PRACTISE / LEGISLATION / REGULATIONS / BY-LAWS

In the planning process of the safety management of the event full recognition has been accorded to the following Codes of Practice, Acts of the Oireachtas and Statutory Regulations etc., where these are considered relevant and practicable for this event:

- Health, Safety and Welfare at Work Act 2005 and associated regulations
- Health and Welfare at Work (General Applications) Regulations 2007 to 2016
- Health and Welfare at Work (Construction) Regulations 2013 (S.I. No. 291 of 2013)
- A Framework for Major Emergency Management
- Code of Practise for Safety at Sports Grounds as issued by the Department of Education, 1996

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- f. Code of Practice for Safety at Outdoor Pop Concerts and other outdoor musical events as issued by the Department of Education, 1996
- g. Guide to Safety at Sports Grounds – Green Guide, UK
- h. The Event Safety Guide – Purple Guide, UK
- i. Fire Safety in Places of Assembly (Ease of Escape) Regulations, 1985
- j. Code of Practice for Management of Fire Safety in Places of Assembly as issued by the Department of Environment
- k. Fire Services Act 1981 and 2003 (responsibility for fire safety on persons in control of premises)
- l. Fire Services (Amendment) Act, 2003

- m. Part XVI Planning and Development Act 2000 (as amended) and the Planning and Development Regulations 2015
- n. The Children First: National Guidance for the Protection and Welfare of Children, updated Children First Act 2015
- o. Waste Management Acts, 1996 and 2001

INSURANCES

INSURANCE

The promoter has submitted evidence of Employer's Liability Insurance €13m and Public Liability €6.5m. An indemnity with regard to Galway City Council has been provided. Relevant specific details of this can be requested from Community and Culture

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SAFETY & OPERATIONS

EVENT SPECIFIC SAFETY STRATEGY

SAFETY POLICY

It is the policy of GIAF to provide a safe environment for this event. It will be achieved by ensuring that all facets of the event are managed in a manner so as to maximise the safety of all those attending and participating, together with the provision of proper safety management systems for all elements of the event. This will be achieved in cooperation with the Event Management team, Chief Steward, An Garda Síochána, Medical, Volunteers as well as all suppliers and stakeholders.

Throughout the planning process Galway International Arts Festival will try to ensure that the attendees have an enjoyable experience in a safe environment. There are many components to this and these are detailed below.

RISK ASSESSMENT

RISK ASSESSMENT

The risk assessments for this event have been developed with the following in mind:

- Hazards may change during the course of the event.
- Risk levels can be dynamic. This necessitates on-going dynamic risk assessment on the part of the Event Management Team during the event.
- The Likelihood and Consequence relating to specific, identified hazards vary depending, predominantly, on where the hazard occurs, what level of risk is apparent and what level of control is required.

The comprehensive risk assessment process undertaken for this event includes the following:

- Identification of foreseeable hazards.
- Establish level of risk of the hazard causing harm or damage
- Establish the likelihood and consequences of those hazards.
- Determine the controls required to eliminate or reduce the level of risk, using the hierarchy of controls.

Consideration is given to design, information and management of the event elements to try to eliminate or at least minimise the risk. The findings of the risk assessment will be continuously updated and documented on the worksheets.

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It is noted that the risk assessment undertaken in connection with this event management plan does take into consideration the hazards and risks from structural elements in the event space, however the Event Management team cannot take responsibility for these hazards and risks that they cannot control, i.e.

- Pavements and kerbs in situ
- Road surfaces
- Underfoot ground conditions
- Permanent walls in situ
- Permanent or non-event fencing and railings
- Street furniture
- Risks of building elements on the public
- Premises/ buildings/sites adjacent to the event space
- Fire/explosion/toxic risks from such premises/sites.
- Terrorist activity
- Bicycles racks and bicycle hire stations

Where required, and safely accessible, the hazard will be confined and accessed restricted.

The event risk assessment for this event is included as an attachment.

BUILD, BREAK, TEMPORARY STRUCTURES

EVENT LAYOUT

Full drawings for the event are included in appendix.

SITE CONSERVATION

All buildings and associated site-works to be always protected.

TEMPORARY BARRIERS

There will be a small number of crowd control barriers (CCB's) used as part of the Safety Management for the event. GIAF are the appointed supplier and as such, they will be erected and dismantled by experienced staff.

BUILD

A comprehensive build and production schedule is being developed and is continuously being updated following communications between the event managers and relevant stakeholders.

The build elements of this event will commence on Thursday 16th July 2026. This will take place at Nimmo's Pier where a base will be set up while the company are in Galway.

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The company have supplied a specific Risk Assessment and Method statement (RAMS) will also require sign off before commencement of build.
Any changes on site will need to be amended on the RAMS prior to works continuing.

The Safety Officer who will ensure adequate measures are taken to ensure people's safety will supervise relevant elements of the build.

BREAK

The break elements of this event will take place immediately after the event in the docks, The Whale Street will be escorted from Spanish Arch after the crowds have moved on.

DAMAGE TO PROPERTY

No element of the event should specifically give rise to damage being caused to any property in and around the event site.

Stewarding and event safety staff will be briefed to maintain a monitoring role in relation to it and to intervene if any damage is seen to be done.

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CROWD SAFETY AND MOVEMENT

EXPECTED NUMBERS

This is a free event. The numbers expected to attend will be approximately 10,000, based on previous year attendance but also very weather dependent if a wet day the numbers will be less.

CAPACITY CALCULATIONS

A review of the event-specific capacity calculations will be carried out and will continue to be reviewed as any amendments or additions occur. These calculations consider all the relevant physical (P) and safety (S) factors, and include:

- Ingress Capacity which relates to the time required for the maximum number of attendees to enter the event through the entry points
- Occupant capacity, which relates to the maximum number of occupants (participants, spectators and personnel), that area can comfortably and safely maintain.
- Circulation space, which is the space available for the participants, spectators and personnel to move around. When calculating, consideration has been given to items such as fixed structures in situ and space given to event elements for example barriers and sterile area, as well as exit routes.
- Egress Capacity which relates to the time required for the maximum number of attendees to exit the event through the exit points.
- Emergency egress that is concerned with the egress capacity in the case of an emergency and ensuring there are sufficient routes for the expected occupants (participants, spectators and personnel).

When reviewing the capacities for the event, various areas and matters are considered and these included:

- Main Entry/Exits
- Emergency routes

It has been established that the venue is a suitable site for the proposed activity. The arrangements are carefully planned to ensure the comfort and safety of the attendees as well as the spectators and personnel working throughout the overall event, and have been developed by the event management team to ensure all have adequate capacity, and these include:

- Clear access routes
- Location and positioning of crowd control barriers
- Location and positioning of stewards and security
- Location and positioning of event related structures
- Occupant and egress routes of event spaces calculated

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- Below are individual Crowd Control Plans and Emergency Plans for Road Junctions and Bridges in the route.

This plan is designed in reference to previous Parades and public spectacles including St Patrick's Parades and Macnas Parades

Eyre Square Crowd Management Plan.

The float and performers will set up on the pedestrian area near the public toilets following a escorted trip from the docks A compound of crowd control barriers will be set up to have the space set aside. There will be no delay once they reach this point for the spectator to begin. Aside from the traffic management plan the pedestrian numbers and audience will need to be monitored at this point as the festival garden will be in operation. Concerns regarding the Corbettcourt shopping centre exit are been addressed.

Staffing

Area manager and security will monitor and move crowds further on the route to view the event. The Whale Street will have 6 security personnel around the structure who purpose is to keep the public clear as it move through the street. They will be assisted by volunteers and Festival staff using rope to create a cordon around Microcosmos.

Following the closure of the road and the event begins and moves on to Williams Street, this street is sufficiently wide enough to deal with expected crowds. Barriers will be stored, and security will be stationed at Abbeygate Streets upper and lower to ensure these streets remain clear and be used for emergency egress. Moving on to Shop Street, barriers and security will be deployed to Church Lane and Buttermilk Lane and ensure they are exit only if needed.

Security will all be need on both ends of Church yard Street as this is the widest and main emergency exit from Shop street. Historically this location has had the greatest crowd density as this location is been fed by High Street and Middle Street.

Security will need to be deployed to these locations if the need to divert pedestrians away from Shop Street.

The performance moves on to Mainguard Street where some street furniture will need to be remove from outside premises. The operations of the bike hire will need to be contacted to close on the hire station and remove bikes to prevent damage and a trip hazard for the public. The other bicycle rack will need to be closed also and signage put up a week in advance to ask public not to use.

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Security will need to be deployed on Cross Street upper and Cross Street lower at the junction of Middle Street again to manage crowds movement and main the street as a emergency route from the performance route.

The performance continues Bridge Street over O'Brien's Bridge. The path running also side the river which exit on Fr Griffin Road will also require security and need to be closed off to stop people taken a short cut to Fr Griffin Road and prevent congestion. The performance will move on to Dominick Street where some restrictions will need to be put in place for cars parked on this street to maintain a safe distance for the performance to pass by the viewing public.

The final leg of the route is to finish outside Monroes and move back to Nimmo's Pier.

Emergency Plan

The spectacle has one float and 6 participants

In the event of emergency vehicles approaching the junction from either direction, Security Staff stationed at other points along the route will radio to Security Staff positioned at the junction, who will direct that The Whale Streetto move to the side of the road until the emergency vehicles have safely transited the junction.

EMERGENCY ACCESS

Access for emergency services will be maintained at all time.

CIRCULATION AND EVACUATION ROUTES

All circulation and evacuation routes will have adequate area to allow for the expected occupancy. Attendees can circulate through the spaces with little or no restrictions however subject to crowd congestion in various locations.

The site is a partially open space. The expected total audience is approximately 10000 people throughout the event. There will be no fenced areas and escape will be available in all directions.

EXITS AND EMERGENCY EXITS

Attendees will be directed through exit routes, referred to Stewards, who will be present to monitor, regulate and manage the crowd, and will supervise all exit routes.

During an emergency the crowd will exit through the nearest exit / route available, and this may be to a place of reasonable safety initially however will lead to an evacuation route.

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SECURITY / STEWARDS

CONSULTATION

Stewarding/Security requirements for this event have been confirmed after consultations between the Event Management Team, the Chief Steward and An Garda Síochána. Relevant experience, expertise, site visits and several meetings have informed these requirements.

STAFFING

This event has been split into a number of component parts for the stewarding plan. This is based on a number of factors, including:

- Event site layout
- Crowd profile Event Timing
- Expected attendance
- Entry / Exit widths
- Consultation with An Garda Síochána

LOCATIONS

The Chief Steward will ensure the following locations are covered at all times as per plan. Periodic checks will be completed of these positions to confirm cover:

- Entrance Points
- Exits Points
- Appropriate location as designated
- Carparks

REDEPLOYMENT

Stewards, security and/or volunteers may be redeployed where required providing that it does not comprise the stewarding of other areas. Any redeployment will be agreed in advance between Chief Steward and the Event Management Team.

BRIEFINGS

It is the responsibility of the Chief Steward to ensure cascade briefings are delivered ensuring that all Stewards are familiar with their responsibilities and duties.

Senior Stewards are required to ensure that all stewards sign in and provide contact details, as well as ensuring they all have necessary contact details and incident report forms to be completed. Any accident/incidents that occur will be fully documented. Report will be issued to GIAF for record purposes.

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All Senior Stewards will be issued with an instructional pack, which will include the following,

- Details of duties required from stewards
- Contact details for key personnel
- Site Map where relevant

MEDICAL PROVISIONS

All medical arrangements will be coordinated by Galway Civil Defence. A full medical plan is attached in the Appendix.

FIRE SAFETY

All reasonable fire safety precautions will be taken during this event.

Fire certificates for materials used in floats and temporary structures to be furnished to parade coordinators.

There are some fireworks in this year display and a more detail plan of these to be furnished in a revised plan.

CAPACITIES/EGRESS/INGRESS

Safe holding capacities for the site been calculated as per Section Crowd Safety & Movement.

To ensure safe exiting of attendees in the case of an emergency, the Safety Officer will ensure all Exit Signage and Communication methods are in place and free from obstruction prior to the event going live.

EQUIPMENT STANDARDS

The promoter will consult with a professional fire safety company to organise for adequate fire equipment.

Once sited the fire safety company will provide on-site certification to confirm all equipment has been tested within the last 11 months and is fit for purpose.

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INFRASTRUCTURE AND INSTALLATIONS

Certification will be requested for all materials, structural linings, bespoke installations and any material deemed relevant.

GENERAL AND COMBUSTIBLE WASTE

Combustible waste and general waste produced as part of this event will be removed as and when required to prevent any build up. This will be the responsibility of the Galway City Council and will be monitored by the Event Management Team.

SMOKING

Under the Public Health (Tobacco) Acts, it has been illegal to smoke in all enclosed workplaces. All Staff working on site will be briefed and this will be monitored on site by all management staff.

Smoking is not permitted in the vicinity of any of the event installations.

ELECTRICAL INSTALLATION & LIGHTING

All lights used in the event are supplied and certified before use. All emergency lighting in the tent will be tested and recertified. All tower lighting for outside use for walkways and exits will be also certified and tested.

WASTE MANAGEMENT

It is the policy of promoter to ensure that there is no build-up of combustible within or as a result of this event. At the time of drawing up the Draft there was no waste been generated by this event.

WASTE STORAGE AND REMOVAL

A post de-rig clean will occur after the build site has been cleared to ensure it is restored to pre-event state.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION

NOISE

All noise will be for a limited period and shall not cause any unreasonable disturbance to any nearby noise sensitive premises.

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TOILETS FACILITIES

Toilets will be made available to staff and participants at Nimmo's Pier at the beginning and end of the parade.

TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT

CONSULTATION

The traffic management arrangements for this event will be established in consultation with An Garda Síochána and Galway City Council. Consideration is given at all times to the impact on general public and all public transport and private providers.

ROAD CLOSURES

There are a series of road closures required for this event. These will be decided on by Garda management and event control depending on the factors occurring at the time.

PARKING

There is parking available throughout the city.

PARKING RESTRICTIONS

There will be parking restrictions on Dominick St and the parking spaces the end of Bridge Street at the Bridge Mills, barriers will be put in place early morning and signage to be erected in this location least 7 days in advance of the spectacle. Any vehicle causing an obstruction will be dealt with in accordance with the road traffic act.

A management plan will need to drawn up for these spaces as there is 2 spectator event.

EMERGENCY ACCESS

Emergency access, if required, will be facilitated as a priority through the nearest access point.

DELIVERIES TO SITE

All deliveries of the float to the docks in the days before the event.

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POLICIES & PROCEDURES

EVENT CONTROL & COMMUNICATIONS

EVENT CONTROL

Event Control will be located upstairs in the Galway Advertiser Offices Eyre Square.

The Event Management Team of four area managers will manage all actions and will have clear communications with working personnel, stewards and An Garda Síochána members.

In the case of a serious or potential Major Emergency the Emergency Team will assume control, which consists of:

- Event Management Team
- Chief Steward
- An Garda Síochána

The Event Management Team will make all necessary decisions until such a time that a Transfer of Primacy is required to the applicable statutory agency.

COMMUNICATIONS

Communication between the Event Management Team and those working on the event is a key component to the Safety Management of the event. The main communications method for this event will be digital two-way radios.

Radios will be allocated to ensure the efficient and effective safe management of the event.

During the event, there will be multiple methods of communicating with the participants and spectators.

They include the following:

- Megaphones will be utilised if required.
- Stewards.
- On the ground event teams.

KEY CONTACTS

The Key Contacts list will be circulated among key members of staff.

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MEGAPHONES

There will be megaphones available for use as required and security will be briefed on pro-active communications with attendees.

LOST AND FOUND

Any items found should be handed into event representatives and logged if possible. At the end of the event lost or found items will be passed to An Garda Síochána.

LOST PERSON

The lost person policy for this event is as follows:

Finds a lost person

- If a team member finds a lost person, they relay this to the Event Management Team using the designated code word “DELTA 1”, along with any pertinent information in relation to the lost person.
- The team member will remain in situ with the lost person for 10-15 minutes or as directed by the Event Management Team. A nearby team member or volunteer may be directed to that area to accompany the team member.
- Depending on the location the team member, along with another team member / volunteer, may be directed to an accessible and easily visible area
- The Children First: National Guidance for the Protection and Welfare of Children, updated Children First Act 2015 will be adhered to with young persons protection to the foremost.
- From when the Event Management Team is informed of the lost person efforts will be made to locate those who were accompanying the lost person.
- the Event Management Team will evaluate each incident individually and decide on the best course of action. This may be to remain in that area.
- Any accident/incidents that occur will be fully documented.
- the Event Management Team will communicate all information to the other agencies.

Report of a lost person,

- If a team member receives a report of a lost person, they relay this to the Event Management Team, using the designated code word “ROGUE 1”, along with key details to include the lost person’s name, age and description and where they were last seen.
- The team member will stay with the reporting person if possible or alternatively obtain a contact name and number at least.

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- From when the Event Management Team is informed of the lost person efforts will be made to locate them.
- The Event Management Team will communicate key details to staff through the two-way radio system

Incident Management Plan:

Incident: Emergency vehicle needs to access to parade route

The event controller on being informed of the incident will immediately replay the following message to all personnel:

“AN EMERGENCY SERVICE VEHICLE NEEDS TO GAIN ACCESS TO THE PARADE ROUTE FROM (INSERT STREET NAME), PLEASE MOVE ALL PARTICIPANTS IN YOUR SECTION TO THE RIGHT HAND SIDE OF THE DIRECTION OF THE PARADE “In this incident all participants are moved to the right hand side of the street to allow vehicle access on the left hand side of the direction of the parade. The audience on the left hand side should stay where they are, but stewards should ask them to move off the road to allow access. A member of Stewarding Personnel will clear all access and egress routes. Two Ambulances will be present on site at the event provided by the Civil Defense. Set positions outlined in the Event plan.

INCIDENT: Fire or other incident in a building/facility adjacent to the parade.

The Garda office on being informed of the incident will immediately inform the Event Controller by radio/phone of the nature and location of the incident who will ensure emergency services are call out/proper action is taken. If the alarm is raised by a member of the public/ others via a 999/ 112 call, the fire service regional control centre (WRCC) will have standing instructions to immediately inform the Event controller. The Event Controller will send a route map and detail access and egress routes in the parade. The Event Controller will request the appropriate orders to Gardaí representative in the room to Officers, Civil Defence and Stewards in the relevant areas, to evacuate the affected part of the venue/route to ensure no further crowd flows into the area. The designated steward will be required to make the correct emergency announcements.

Incident: Crowd Surge / Crushing / Congestion / Over Crowding in the Venue / Route

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Any member of event control staff of the three principal response agencies will inform the Event Controller.

The event controller will inform the Stewards in the relevant area to:
Implement the appropriate crowd diversion plan for that area. Once the access street has been closed except to exiting audience, all crowds will be diverted to areas specified by the controller. The designated area Head Steward will be instructed to make the appropriate emergency evacuation announcements.

Incident: Person Falling In River

Preventative measures will be in place. These measures include a number of stewards backed up with members of Claddagh Watch will be briefed accordingly where they will advise the public not to sit on the bridge wall. The Fire Service will be called directly through 999 should a person fall into the river.
Persons will be rescued in accordance with the standard emergency procedures for water rescue.

Incident: Infiltration of route or Reviewing stand by Uninvited Groups

The Area supervisor or Area Garda officer will immediately inform the Event controller identifying the extent and the location of the incident.
The event controller, Senior Garda office in charge will issue the appropriate orders to Garda officers/stewards in the relevant area to:
Implement the appropriate crowd diversion plan for that area/Reviewing stand. Once the access street/Reviewing stand has been closed except to exiting audience, all crowds will be diverted to areas specified by the controller and senior Garda Officer.
The designated area Head Steward will be instructed to make the appropriate emergency evacuation announcements.

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2.3 Health and Safety Statement

Adam Fitzsimons - Event Director

Frank Commins - Event Controller

- Relevant responsible parties as named of this document will be responsible for the overall safety and management of The Galway International Arts Festival CPPP The Whale Street street spectacle.
- The parade director will coordinate pre-planning meetings with all of the above named responsible parties.
- The events controller will ensure that all stewards are briefed prior to the parade on effective stewarding techniques, safety and first aid procedure; fire safety management and emergency response plans.
- Radios issued to stewards will be tested prior to the parade.
- Event control will have 8 cameras along the route viewed in event control room.
- The events controller will co-ordinate the technical aspects of the arrangements insofar as they impinge on safety matters; pay particular attention to crowd control and densities, monitor first aid and rescue tactics paying particular attention to alleviate any perceived risks.
- The Event Control Room will be positioned above the Galway Advertiser offices where the event can be viewed. A representative from the stewarding team and a radio from the Civil Defence will be present in this room throughout the event. A member of An Garda Siochana will be positioned into the Event Control Room to maximize communication plans should an emergency arise. In case of an emergency please make your way to this point.
- In the event of mobile networks going down make a call through a member of An Garda Siochana from radio TETRA network.

2.4 Parade Staff Emergency Communications Procedure

- Should a Major Emergency be declared this would become the designated On-Site Control Centre (OSCC). This is where the Controllers of Operations of the three Principal Response Agencies (PRAs) will convene along with the Head Steward of the Festival and other if required. (to be confirmed) the communications steward will be based here and contact number is (to be confirmed)
- Parade staff when communicating with the PRA's will use the ETHANE format when possible.

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- Exact Location
- Type of incident
- Hazard present and potential
- Access to the Location of the incident and the egress routes
- Number and severity of casualties
- Emergency services present and required at the scene.

Incidents

If you discover an incident immediately inform Event Control by one of the following means:

- Radio (however in the event of suspect packages do not use your radio)
- Telephone Event Control
- Make your way to the Civil Defense Vehicle located in front of Bank of Ireland Eyre Square

In relaying information about an incident do not use emotive words such as FIRE.

The descriptive words are:

- USA for Fire
- UKRAINE for Crowd Disturbance

When an incident has been discovered event control will issue a general broadcast via the radio. The general broadcast will be as follows:

“GENERAL BROADCAST FROM EVENT CONTROL TO ALL UNITS. THERE IS A (DESCRIPTION OF THE NATURE OF THE INCIDENT, E.G. USA IN THE (LOCATION E.G. SHOP STREET)

This message will then be repeated.

After an assessment of the incident the event controller, safety officer and Gardaí will agree on the actions to be deployed including consideration of the following:

- If the incident can be contained
- Whether to issue a standby or evacuation message
- Whether a part or full evacuation is necessary and the location of the evacuation points

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STAND BY

Event control will issue a standby message over the radio:

“WILL THE (REQUIRED PERSONNEL) PLEASE GO TO THE (SCENE OF THE INCIDENT)”

Event Control will wait for confirmation from all commands that instructions are complete.

EVACUATION ACTIONS

All channels will be notified evacuation message with reference to the designated exits/assembly points.

Where public address and megaphones are available event control/head stewards issues the following public evacuation message:

‘LADIES AND GENTLEMEN DUE TO CIRCUMSTANCES THAT HAVE ARISEN IT WILL NOT BE POSSIBLE TO CONTINUE TODAYS EVENT AND YOU ARE REQUIRED TO LEAVE THE VIEWING AREA AS QUICKLY AND QUIETLY AS POSSIBLE FOLLOWING THE DIRECTION OF STEWARDS.’

Monitor in consultation with others the safe evacuation of patrons/staff from the area.

POST EVACUATION PLANS

Receive acknowledgement from all commands that:

- Evacuation is complete
- All areas are clear

STAND DOWN ACTIONS

If evacuation is not required request event control issues the stand down message to all commands.

“THE PREVIOUS MESSAGE FOR THE (STAFF MEMBER) IS CANCELLED”

This message should then be repeated.

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Emergency plans

EMERGENCY CONTROLLER

The Emergency Controller, in the event of an emergency situation and following a Transfer of Primacy from the Event Management Team, has specific responsibility for the implementation of the Emergency Management Plan appropriate to the given situation.

The Emergency Controller may, as required, be one of the following:

- Senior member of An Garda Síochána
- Senior Fire Officer
- Senior Ambulance Officer

The plan of all Principal Response Agencies would be implemented in the event of a declared Major Emergency.

The objective of the Emergency Plan is to outline the procedures to be adopted in the event of an emergency being declared at the event, or somewhere with proximity such that it has an impact on the event and the safety of those in attendance.

POTENTIAL EMERGENCY SITUATIONS

Emergency situations, by their nature, can take many forms and comprise many elements. That said, there are some emergency situations, which have been known to occur at events more than others. They include:

- Weather
- Environmental Issue
- Fire
- Crowd Disorder
- Medical / Health Emergency
- Structural Compromising / Collapse
- Explosion
- Bomb Threat

KEY COMMUNICATION POINTS

In the event of an emergency, the following are key communication points:

- Location of the actual emergency
- Staff on scene – numbers and competencies
- Assessment of casualties and risks

DEFINITIONS

A **serious incident** can be defined as ‘circumstance or potential circumstance, which has caused or has potential to cause, injury to people or damage to property or the

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environment which can be managed by the resources immediately available on site such as stewards/security, medical and/or Emergency Services’. Examples include:

- Outbreak of small fire
- Minor crowd disorder
- Medical incidents affecting an individual or small number of people

An **emergency** can be defined as ‘circumstance or potential circumstance, which has caused or has potential to cause, serious injury to people or damage to property or the environment requiring an immediate response including the deployment of resources from the event management team and/or principal emergency services (An Garda Síochána, Ambulance service, Fire service).’ The principal emergency services will be requested to assist in the response and will work in conjunction with event management.

A **major emergency** can be defined as ‘circumstance or potential circumstance which has caused or has potential to cause severe injury and/or loss of life and which is beyond the capabilities of resources on site and/or additional available resources brought in to assist’.

Under a Framework for Major Emergency Management a Major Emergency is defined as: “Any event which, usually with little or no warning, causes or threatens death or injury, serious disruption of essential services or damage to property, the environment or infrastructure beyond the normal capabilities of the principle emergency services in the area in which the event occurs, and requires the activation of specific additional procedures and the mobilization of additional resources to ensure an effective, coordinated response”.

Any accident/incidents that occur will be fully documented. Report will be issued to Galway City Council for record purposes

ACTIVATION OF EMERGENCY PLAN

During all normal operations management and control of the event rests with the Event Management Team

If a situation occurs which is beyond the normal capabilities of the Event Management team to manage, after consultation with key personnel including:

- the Event Management Team
- Medical Coordinator
- Chief Steward

The Event Management Team will consult with Galway City Council and advise that a Transfer of Primacy may be required. The Transfer of Primacy will state that when the

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Emergency Plan is implemented due to an incident occurring, the event management team will no longer manage the event.

The Event Controller will consult with the Principle Response Agency (PRA) advising them of the situation, and the PRA's will coordinate an effective response. The lead PRA representative, if required, will then declare a major emergency.

In practical terms, a Major Emergency exists when it is apparent that the safety management and medical management resources in place at the event are not sufficient and external resources will be required.

TRANSFER OF PRIMACY

Transfer of responsibility from the Event Management Team to an Emergency Controller, and transfer back, will be logged in the Event Log and will also involve the signing of the Transfer of Primacy form. Attached as an Appendix.

EMERGENCY CONTROLLER

The Emergency Controller shall take control over the entire operation unless or until the circumstances of the emergency dictate otherwise, i.e., the Senior Fire Officer present would take a major fire in charge. In this event the Emergency Controller would be responsible for keeping the emergency area clear.

LOCATION OF EMERGENCY

The location of the actual emergency must be clearly identified by the Emergency Controller before deciding which options in the emergency plan are to be activated.

FACILITIES

The Event Management Team shall ensure that all facilities and staff required for the emergency are made available.

DIVERSION

If the Emergency Controller considers that a full (or at least substantial) diversion is required, he/she will inform the Event Management Team, who will assist with the management of the diversion. This decision can only be taken on the occurrence of an agreed major emergency. All patrons will be directed away from the emergency towards the nearest emergency route, which may be manned.

EMERGENCY ACCESS ROUTE

All relevant emergency services will be made aware of the emergency routes in advance of the event. This happens as part of the event management planning process. All

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responding emergency vehicles will access via the most appropriate access route, depending on the emergency and its location. There will be regular communications with the Event Management Team to allow for adequate support for access from event personnel.

The designated emergency access routes are agreed between the relevant parties and will be communicated to all applicable parties at the event day briefing.

FUNCTIONS

The functions of the Local Authority, the Gardaí and Health Service Executive in the event of an emergency at the event are in accordance with those set out below. Generally, Gardaí, Emergency Planning Office, Fire Service and Ambulance Service will produce the emergency service's Major Emergency Plan.

The Event Organisers and Management Team

The functions of the Organiser shall be:

- To place all facilities in the location at the disposal of the Emergency Controller;
- To provide areas suitable for collection of casualties, first aid treatment etc.;
- To provide drawings of the location to the Emergency Controller;
- To place all available personnel at the disposal of the Emergency Controller.

Gardaí Síochána

The Gardaí shall carry out their functions in accordance with the provisions of the plan and in addition they shall operate in accordance with their own codified instructions:

- Activation of the plan;
- Maintenance of law and order.
- Evacuation;
- Traffic and crowd control;
- Preservation of scene and collection of evidence.
- Arrangements in respect of the dead;
- Provision of a casualty information service at the site;
- Establishment an information centre for use by the agencies responding;
- Securing the location and layout thereof and controlling access thereto;
- Exercise of certain functions pending a local authority response to an emergency;
- Informing the public as necessary and on the advice to the competent authorities of actual or potential disasters arising from the emergency.

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Local Authorities

The Local Authorities shall carry out all of its functions in accordance with the provisions of the plan, as well as:

- Activation of the plan
- Maintenance of all services during the emergency
- Accommodation and welfare of evacuees and persons displaced by the emergency
- Provision of food and rest facilities for personnel responding to the emergency

Galway Fire Service

Galway Fire service shall carry out all its functions in accordance with the provisions of the plan, as well as:

- Activation of the plan
- Extinction of fires
- Containment, neutralisation and clearance of chemical spills and emissions
- Protection of rescue of persons and property
- Provision of access to the site of the emergency
- Forensic support for Gardaí
- Advise on evacuation
- Site clearance, demolition, clean-up operations, removal and disposal of debris
- Control and direction of activities of all agencies within the “Danger Area” at an emergency

HSE

HSE shall carry out all of its functions in accordance with the provisions of the plan, as well as:

- Declaration of a Major Emergency and notifying the other two relevant principal response agencies.
- Activation of predetermined procedures/arrangements in accordance with its Major Emergency Mobilisation Procedure.
- Acting as lead agency, where this is determined in accordance with Appendix F7 (of the Framework), and undertaking the specified coordination function;
 - Provision of medical advice and assistance;
 - Provision of medical aid to casualties at the site;
 - Triage of casualties, and assigning them to hospitals for evacuation;
 - Casualty evacuation and ambulance transport;
 - Provision of hospital treatment;
 - Provision of psycho-social support to persons affected by the emergency;
 - Certification of the dead;
 - Support for An Garda Síochána forensic work;

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- Support for the Coroner's role;
- Clinical decontamination and decontamination of contaminated persons on arrival at hospital;
- Advising and assisting An Garda Síochána and Local Authorities on public health issues arising;
- Exercising control of any voluntary or other service which it mobilises to the site;
- Monitoring and/or reporting on the impact in its functional area of any emergency/crisis which falls within the ambit of a "National Emergency", and coordinating/undertaking any countermeasures in its functional area which are required/recommended by an appropriate national body;
- Any other function, related to its normal functions, which is necessary for the management of the emergency/crisis;
- Any function which the On-Site Co-ordinating Group requests it to perform; and,
- Maintaining essential health services during the Major Emergency

EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

RESTRICTING OPERATIONS

Every effort will be made to ensure that the event proceeds smoothly; it is imperative to plan for all unforeseen circumstances in order to ensure public safety. It may be necessary to stop, curtail or limit the event in the interest of safety. If an event has to be stopped, curtailed or limited, it will only occur upon the direction of the Event Management Team.

There are certain factors that will be considered when deciding to stop, curtail or limit the event these are as follows:

- Advice from the Medical Coordinator
- Advice from the Chief Steward
- Advice from the Statutory Agencies

CONTINGENCY PLANS

In the planning for this event a range of eventualities have been considered, which may come to pass. This is not an exhaustive list but is informed by experience of events and eventualities.

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INCLEMENT WEATHER

The event is outdoors and therefore exposed to all the weather elements. There are no facilities specifically for shelter provided by the event organisers. Stewards will be briefed to assist where possible and without endangering themselves.

PRE-EVENT

The event management will monitor the forecasts and communicate directly with Met Eireann if required to establish the most accurate forecast, and to take guidance from the advisory service available.

DURING THE EVENT

Weather conditions will be continuously monitored and noted. If adverse weather conditions occur the Event Management Team, will decide if the event should be temporarily postponed or cancelled.

In the event of extreme conditions, sudden heavy rain or wind etc. the following will occur:

- the Event Management Team will communicate with the key personnel and advise of actions
- Stewards and event team will direct attendees away from any temporary infrastructure and advise to take shelter where possible
- Medical will review and communicate with NEOC if required
- Emergency announcements will be made to advise attendees to evacuate the area as required.
- The Event Management Team will continue to monitor the conditions and when safe to do so the Event Management Team will decide if the event can resume or to cancel completely.

FAILURE OF EQUIPMENT

- The contractor will carry out pre-event inspections early to determine all equipment is working correctly.(Floats and Vehicles) Report to the Event Management Team if attention is needed. The Event Management Team will decide promptly to replace equipment if repairs are not successful.
- All applicable personnel will set up the crowd control barriers in advance of the event to establish that all are sufficient to use with the general public. Take out of use, any which may cause further hazards.
- The Safety Officer will visually inspect all temporary structures.

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DELAYS

- The Event Management Team will try to ensure that there are no delays to the start however will have Key Personnel briefed just in case.
- Stewards will be in fixed positions throughout the event space to monitor the progress.
- The Event Management Team will communicate with the Senior Garda Síochána present to establish assistance if required.

SHORTAGE OF PERSONNEL

- At sign in any shortages will be identified. If applicable the Event Controller will organise for additional external personnel to be directed to the event and will continue to trouble-shoot.
- Personnel will be redeployed if necessary
- There is a contingency of 10% with all personnel

CANCELLATION POLICY

PRE-EVENT

In case of cancellation the Event Management Team will inform all key personnel and Statutory Agencies and the communication plan will be activated to contact external parties. The Event Management Team will:

- Inform all key personnel of the cancellation who will in turn ensure that all personnel, event stewards and all other relevant parties are briefed before initiating cancellation
- If staff are on site already, send out a radio alert to all personnel that the event is being postponed/ cancelled
- Assign some first aid personnel to the key areas
- Instruct the PA announcer and/or personnel with loud hailer to make the following announcements informing any public who may be present:
 - “Ladies and gentlemen, we regret that for reasons beyond our control, today’s event has been postponed / cancelled. We apologise for any inconvenience. Thank you for your support and patience”.
- Consult with the Event PR team regarding messages on social media.
- Monitor any areas where spectators may have gathered
- Provide information to Chief Steward relating to the event.
- Notify the Gardaí if any crowd disturbances arise

Event stewards will adopt the following procedures:

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- Prohibit admittance to unauthorised locations
- Keep emergency routes clear
- Remain courteous to all attendees and provide information to them when requested

DURING THE EVENT

In case of cancellation of performance, the Event Management Team will inform all key personnel and Statutory Agencies and the communication plan will be activated to contact external parties. The Event Management Team will:

- Inform all key personnel of the cancellation who will in turn ensure that all personnel, event stewards and security are briefed before initiating cancellation
- Send out a radio alert to all personnel that the event is being postponed / cancelled
- Assign some first aid personnel to the key areas
- Instruct the personnel with loud hailer to make the following announcements informing any public who may be present:
 - “Ladies and gentlemen, we regret that for reasons beyond our control, today’s event has been postponed/cancelled. We apologise for any inconvenience. Thank you for your support and patience”.
- Provide information to Chief Steward relating to the event
- Notify the Gardaí if any crowd disturbances arise.
- Consult with the Event PR Team regarding messages on social media.

All key personnel will supervise and assist:

- Attendees external to the event space on proposed ingress into the venue.
- Manage crowds to ensure a calm and control egress and avoid contra-flows forming.
- Remain courteous to all and provide information to them when requested
- Keep emergency routes clear

EVENT HEALTH & SAFETY DOCUMENTATION & INSPECTIONS

TESTS AND INSPECTIONS

It is the responsibility of the Safety Officer to ensure that all appropriate tests and inspections are carried out at all stages of the event.

PRE-EVENT

During the planning phase of the event the Safety Officer will:

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- Ensure that all relevant Statutory Agencies and stakeholders are aware of and expressly agree to everything in the event management plan
- Manage all contractors, ensuring adequate provisions, arrangements and documentation are in place with regard to safety
- Ensure that any build elements are carried out safely and adequately, that all safety documentation is provided and, where required.

PRE-SHOW

In advance of the event opening to the public, the Safety Officer will:

- Ensure sufficient numbers of personnel and stewards are on hand
- Ensure all medical and fire-fighting arrangements are in place
- Ensure all signage is in place
- Ensure all entry and exit routes are free from obstruction and trip hazards
- Ensure that all emergency exits and routes are fully operational
- Ensuring all public-address systems are functioning
- Ensure there is no build-up of combustible waste
- Ensure there is no hazardous waste materials on site

DURING

During the course of the event, the Safety Officer will:

- Monitor crowd movement
- Respond to any incidents or accidents
- Monitor the event site for any changes that may represent a safety issue
- Ensure the status of all elements remain the same.
- Ensure all staff members are playing their part in ensuring safety

EVENT END

As the event finishes, the Safety Officer will:

- Monitor egress, ensuring all spectators exit from the area safely.
- Ensure the de-rig / break down of any elements is done in a safe manner
- Ensure the removal of any combustible waste
- Ensure the event site is reinstated as per event management plan

STAFF HEALTH & SAFETY PROCEDURES

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Under Section 8 of the Safety, Health and Welfare at Work Act 2005 the employer has a duty to ensure employees' safety, health and welfare at work as far as reasonably practicable.

All contractors on site will be required to follow this legislation with their employees.

Management will ensure that there is provision for:

- Welfare facilities for all employees on site including break out area, designated sanitary facilities.
- Provide and maintain a safe workplace which uses safe plant and equipment
- Prevent risks from use of any article or substance and from exposure to physical agents, noise and vibration.
- Prevent any improper conduct or behaviour likely to put the safety, health and welfare of employees at risk
- Provide instruction and training to employees on health and safety on site.
- Providing protective clothing and equipment to employees were required.

Employees on site will be expected to follow Section 13 of the act. This includes:

- Taking reasonable care to protect the health and safety of themselves and of other people on the event site.
- Not to engage in improper behaviour that will endanger themselves or others
- Not to be under the influence of drink or drugs in the workplace
- To report any defects in the place of work or equipment which might be a danger to health and safety.
- To report any incidents during the build phase and during event live with the management team.

ACCESSIBILITY

ACCESS TO PARADE

A designated disability wheelchair area has to be identified yet .

PARKING

There will be normal on-street parking outside of the parade route. The organisers would encourage the use of public transport.

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GUIDE DOGS

Guide or Assistance dogs will be permitted to the event.

SUPPORT

Stewards and Volunteers will be briefed prior to the event on methods of support for people on site and facilities available.

COMMUNITY GAIN

It is anticipated that this event will have a positive impact on the local community and as such will result in new and returning patrons to the event.

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Appendix

RISK ASSESSMENT COVERING ALL VENUES

EVENT	CPPP The Whale Street 2026	RA REVISION	Draft
CLIENT	Galway International Arts Festival	COMPLETED BY	Frank Commins
EVENT DATE	17 th 18 th of July 2026	DATE OF ASSESSMENT	16 th April 2026
EVENT LOCATION	The streets of Galway		

HAZARD	RISK	AFFECTED	CONTROL	RESPONSIBILITY	RESIDUAL RISK		
					L	C	R
Use of contractors	Risk of personal injury from actions of contractors Damage to property	All personnel on site General public	- All contractors to be competent and experienced to fulfil their individual and team functions. - All contractors advise if they are using subcontractors with understanding they are responsible for ensuring any subcontractors are informed of key event information. - Contractors are responsible for the actions and supervisions of their own teams and any subcontractors.	Event promoter Contractors	2	3	6

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			• Adequate coordination on site to include the actions of all contractors. • Adequate communications to all contractors regarding site rules and expectations. • All contractors submit sufficient insurance, risk assessments, method statements, drawings, specs etc as required.				
Use of equipment / machinery / build elements / structures	Risk of personal injury from interaction with or fault damaged items. structural elements.	All personnel on site General public	• Area must be secure before any works commence for the safety of all personnel and contractors. • Contractors must be provided with a sterile / contained working space with no unauthorised access. All event build area must be kept sterile for the general public. • Each contractor must be aware of other contractors on site and adjust their work activities accordingly. • Contractors must use a banksman where required. • All deliveries must be scheduled with the Event Manager. • No vehicles are to access the work areas. • All equipment, plant, facilities, build elements etc. to be appropriate for the setting and fit for purpose. • All equipment, plant, facilities, build elements etc. to be used by competent personnel only.	Event promoter Contractors	2	4	8

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			- Only licensed drivers are permitted to operate and control any plant on site. - Keys are not to be left in any unattended vehicles. - All personnel on site must wear full PPE at all times.				
Working at Height	Risk of personal injury or fatality Damage to property	All personnel on site General Public	- Where work at height (W@H) is required safe systems of work should be established and proper planning and organisation occur. - All contractors submit sufficient insurance, risk assessments, method statements, drawings etc as required. - Use of smaller A frame ladders is permitted once the user - Do not overreach – keep both feet on the same rung and belt buckle (e.g.) between the stiles. - Does not straddle the A frame ladder. - Does not carry out work which causes sideways loading - Does not work on or above the top three rungs or two steps for stepladders - Does not attempt to move the ladder while standing on the rungs - Sufficiently secures the base - Uses a buddy system.	Event promoter Contractor	2	4-5	8-10

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			• Ladders are not to be used for prolonged use of time or if the activity involves stretching or overhead works etc. For prolonged works or overhead work a suitable MEWP should be used by a competent user only. • Users of the MEWP must be trained and insured specifically for this work.				
Ladder (straight / Extension / A-frame)	Risk of personal injury Falls, fractures, head injuries	All on site personal Contract ors	• Ladders are not to be used for prolonged use of time or if the activity involves stretching or overhead works etc. For prolonged work or overhead work a suitable MEWP should be used by a competent user only. • Ladder is suitable for the work that is to be carried out • Visual check to be completed before works begin • Extension ladders overlap as per the manufacturer's instructions and locking devices are used • Work must not be carried out need over head lines • Set up must be on a firm level base, • Ladders must be leaning at a suitable angle • Ladders must be tied off or footed when in use. • Ladder to be placed on ground if not in use and not tied off. • Access ladder to be tied off and must extend 3 rungs past the landing point	All personnel on site	3	2	6

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			- Ladder must be barrier off or away from pedestrians and moving vehicles 3 points must be maintained at all times when using a ladder - Step Ladders are not to be straddled and the top 3 rungs should not be used				
Props	Risk of personal injury Cuts, burns, falling objects	Production teams Performers	- All props to be stored securely - Only suitable materials to be used in props – no sharp edges, - All props must be complete and any paints, dyes or glue must be fully dry before the prop is put into use - Props that are to eaten or drunk must be stored in completed with local food safety standards - Props to be suitable for their intended use and the performer (adult / child)	Production teams performers	2	3	6
Loading / Unloading	Risk of personal injury – Crushed, trapped, struck by vehicles,	All on site personal Contractors General public	- Access restricted to loading/unloading areas - Loading/unloading area to be clear marked - Loading/unloading area to be firm and level - Only vehicles suitable for the loads with sufficient anchor points to be used - Vehicles to be barked, chocked and or stabilised during loading and unloading to prevent slippages - Loads to be evenly spread	All on site personal Contractors Public	5	2	10

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	falling objects, falls from vehicles		• Loads to be secure for transport • Vehicles must not be overloaded • Only trained and competent person to use machinery for loading and unloading vehicles • Pedestrians must be protected at all times. Roadside loading and unloading to be avoid whenever possible • Drivers must be provided with a safe area while vehicles are be loaded or unloaded. • Loads must be checked for stability before securing restraints are removed • The need to work are height must be addressed before loading or unloading vehicles. • Safe access to the load must be provided				
Manual Handling	Risk of personal injury back injury repetitive strain	All personnel on site General Public	• Assess all manual handling operations and review requirements. • Ensure there are clear procedures and mechanical aides present for manual handling operations. • Ensure all applicable personnel are adequately trained. Training is the responsibility of the individual suppliers / contractors / team • No general public to be involved in any activity involving manual handling.	All personnel on site	2	3	6

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Fire	Risk of serious personal injury	All personnel	• Consideration of fire risks throughout all parts of the event. • Fire-fighting equipment will be available on site at designated fire point locations. • Fire risk assessment carried out by a designated supplier. • Constant monitoring by personnel for any fire related issues. • Continuous removal of combustible waste. • Security trained and briefed in safe use of firefighting equipment. • Presence of medical providers to respond to any fire safety medical incidents. • Emergency procedures in place to contact emergency services when applicable. • Pre-event consultation with emergency services.	Fire Safety provider	2	4	8
	Burns injuries Damage to property	General Public		Stewards			
Lighting Equipment	Risk of personal injury Burns, Amputation	Contractors General Public	• All lighting equipment to be installed and used as per manufacturer's instructions. • Lighting equipment to be inspected and any defective equipment removed • All lighting equipment will be battery powered. • All lighting equipment must be stable when installed to ensure it does not fall, topple or collapse.	Contractors	1	1	1

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	crush injuries		- Equipment must be disconnected and allowed to cool before maintenance work, removable for storage is permitted. - No combustible materials to be located within the vicinity of lights when they are installed - Lights should be installed out of reach or must be of a suitable low voltage with 'Caution Hot Surface' Warning signs				
Manually Operated Hand Tools	Risk of personal injury Cuts, Lacerations burns	Contract ors Vendors	- Visual inspection of all tools to be completed before use. - Users must be aware of the possible risk of using hand tools - Adequate lighting must be in place be tools are used	Contractors Vendors	2	1	2
Power Hand Tools	Risk of personal injury Burns, entanglement fractures,	Contract ors	- All tool to be maintained and used as per manufacturer's instructions. - Appropriate PPE to be worn when necessary - Tools to be powered out to allow for adjustment of changing of parts, removing blockages - Only competent persons shall be allowed to use power tools	Contractors	3	3	9

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	lacerations, amputation		- Loose clothing or jewellery should not be worn when using power tool - Long hair must not be loose while using power tools. - Only 110v Tools may be used on site. - All tool to have a visual check before tool is used - Work space to be clear before work starts - Portable tools must be PAT tested and labelled annually - Records of PAT testing to be available on request				
Knives and Sharp Objects	Risk of personal injury Cuts, Lacerations, Amputation, puncture wounds	All on site personnel Contractors	- The use of knives and blades to be kept to a minimum. - Only retractable blades to be used on site - Knives and sharp object to be stored securely - All knives, blades must be well maintained and kept sharp - Visual inspection of tool to be completed before use - The correct tool must be used for the task to be completed - PPE to be worn when required	All on site personnel Contractors	3	2	6
Slips, Trips and Falls	Risk of personal injury from	All personnel on site.	- Regular inspections carried out to ensure there are no avoidable slip, trip or fall hazards. - Ensure all unavoidable hazards are adequately managed and highlighted to minimise risk of injury.	Event promoter Stewards	2	3	6

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	a slip, trip or fall	General public	- Constant monitoring by all personnel. - Any damage giving rise to a hazard to be managed immediately to avoid unnecessary risk.				
Ineffective or lack of communications	Risk of personal injury	All personnel on site General Public	- All key personnel must be in contact with the Event Controller by appropriate means. - Use of appropriate radio communications such as two-way radios. - Any defects or issues must be addressed asap. - Alternative means of communication with the crowd such as loud hailers are in place if required. - Key contacts list to be circulated with Event Management Plan.	Event promoter	2	2	4
Movement of mass crowds	Risk of personal injury from movement of large crowds Crush injuries,	All personnel on site General Public	- Adequate capacity and flow rates to be calculated for areas available and locations to be monitored to ensure maximum capacity is not exceeded. - Adequate space and exits for expected crowds at applicable areas. - Constant visual monitoring in all locations and communications with the safety team to minimise crowd congestion. - Sufficient and applicable crowd control barriers used as necessary.	Event promoter Stewards	2	3	6

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	Damage to property		• Access to the back of house and unauthorised areas restricted by barriers and/or security. • Crowd movement monitored pre, during and post events to manage crowd build up and possible pinch points. • Clear agreement between all applicable organisations. • Adequate arrangements and procedures for the movement of such crowds, including emergency procedures. • All personnel are adequately briefed pre-event. • Adequate staffing levels who are trained in their role. • Spectators diverted promptly from busy areas and restrict access if necessary				
Overcrowding	Risk of personal injury Panic attacks	All personnel on site General Public	• Continuous visual monitoring of crowds • Arrangements in place to divert any crowds promptly and effectively before any issues • Experienced stewards on location	Event promoter Stewards	2	2	4
Public Order	Risk of serious personal	All personnel	• Presence of licensed security to monitor and report any issues. • Presence of An Garda Síochana to manage any incidents on site.	Event promoter	1	2	2

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	injury from incident, Damage to property	General Public		An Garda Síochana			
Violence / Aggression / Theft	Risk of personal injury , Ill health, Serious injury, Mental health	All personnel General Public	- Stewards to be to be vigilant of crowd behaviour, temperament. - Volatile situations highlighted to Chief Steward or Gardaí to be informed. - All to be briefed on the security arrangements. - Lone working is avoided where possible. - All incidents for abuse, threat or robbery to be recorded and reviewed - Workplace to be designed to minimise the number of vulnerable areas - Physical barriers to be in place where there is an increase threat if violence.	Event promoter Stewards	2	3	6
Collision involving Pedestrian and Vehicle	Risk of personal injury Damage to vehicle	All personnel General Public	- Advance communication and agreements regarding the traffic management with Garda and stewards. Road closures and vehicle curfew once the event commences. - Designated pedestrian route using footpaths in situ.	Stewards	2	2	4

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			• Advance communication to all event vehicle owners / operators with respect to conduct & movement on site during build, break and when the event is live. • Adherence to advance communications and instructions on the day from Safety Management personnel • All collisions will be reported to An Garda Síochana who will respond as required.				
Lost person	Risk of undue duress, personal injury	General Public	• A lost person policy in place that will be communicated to all personnel in advance. • Stewards and key personnel on radio communications to convey all messages to and from event control.	Promotors	4	1	4
Medical Emergency	Risk of serious personal injury, fatality from medical incident	All personnel General Public	• Presence of medical providers to respond to and manage any/all medical incidents. • Basic training carried out with selective teams pre-event. • Pre-event communications with HSE pre-event.	Medical provider	3	3	9

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Serious Incident / Major Emergency	Risk of personal injury fatality from incident Damage to property	All personnel General Public	• Pre plan and prepare for serious incidents and/or emergency plans. • Communications with Garda regarding any credible intelligence. • Contingency plans agreed with all the primary response agencies. • Clear agreement between all applicable organisations. • An all risk approach is taken. • All personnel briefed in emergency procedures and applicable code words.	Promotor Stewards	2	5	10
Outdoor work	Risk of Personal injury , sunburn, sun stroke, allergies, - bites -soil	All on site personal	• All to be advised of the damages of sun and hydration. • Limit work in direct sun when UV levels are at their highest (2 to 3pm) • Suitable clothing and gloves to be worn when working with soil or in damp areas. • Cuts and abrasions to be covered with waterproof plasters or dressings • Dust must be kept to a minimum • Suitable clothing to be worn when working in bad weather conditions	All on site personal	3	2	6

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Standing for long periods	Risk of personal injury , Fatigue, Back, Neck and shoulder injury	All on site Personal General Public	• Suitable seating to be provided where appropriate • Rotate staff between stand and walk / sitting positions • Breaks to be provided in an area with seating provided • Suitable footwear to be worn	All on site Personal	3	3	9
Sitting for long Periods	Risk of personal injury form fixed position / posture Fatigue, Back, neck or shoulder pain	All on site Personal General Public	• Suitable, supportive seating to be provide • Rotate staff between stand and walking / sitting positions • Seating area to be designed to avoid overreaching or awkward posture. • Clear leg space to be provided • Posture / position to be changed as often as possible • Suitable room temperature to be maintained.	All on site staff Vendors	3	3	9
Lone worker	Risk of personal jury –	All personal on site	• Communication between lone worker and supervision, event team	All personal on site	3	2	6

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	Ill health, Serious injuries		• Contact number to readily available to use in the case of emergency • Check in system to be in place at end of lone working period. • Supervision to be aware of lone workers location and predicted finish time • Lone worker to be trained in lone working procedures • Physical barriers to be in place where there is an increased threat of violence • Lone worker to be provided with background information where required • Number of lone workers on site to be kept to a minimum.				
Weather Conditions	Risk of personal injury Damage to property	All personnel on site General Public	• Communications with Met Eireann • Monitor conditions during all elements of the event including build and derig. • Clear procedures will be agreed and developed regarding adverse weather conditions. These procedures will be communicated to all applicable to implement if/when required.	Promotor	3	3	9

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Damage to property	Risk of personal injury , fatality from incident	All personnel General Public	- Pre plan and prepare for serious incidents and/or emergency plans. - Contingency plans agreed with all the primary response agencies. - Clear agreement between all applicable organisations. - An all risk approach is taken. - All personnel briefed in emergency procedures and applicable code words.	Promotor Stewards	2	2	4
Fall into river	Risk of Personnel injury fatality from incident	All personnel on site General Public	- Pre plan and prepare for serious incidents and/or emergency plans. - Contingency plans agreed with all the primary response agencies. - Clear agreement between all applicable organisations.	All personnel on site General Public	2	3	9
Legionnaires Disease	Risk of personnel injury disease, infection	All personnel on site General Public	- Fixed water systems are designed, installed and maintained to reduce the spread of infection - Water temperature in fixed system to be outside of 20-50 degrees Celsius range - Temperature control system to be in place to reduce the risk of scalding	All personnel on site General Public	2	3	6

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			Stagnant water to be removed for the area or the area barriered off				
Weil's Disease	Risk of personnel injury fever, headaches, chills, severe muscle pain in the calves and thighs, vomiting, diarrhoea bloodshot eyes	All personnel General Public	- Frequent washing of hands - Staying away from water - Cover all cuts, scratches and abrasions with a waterproof dressing. - Wear protective clothing especially gloves when handling soil, vegetation, animal feeds, tools or equipment that may be contaminated. - Avoid touching your mouth and nose. - Food stuffs should not be consumed in the work area	All personnel on site General Public	2	3	6

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TRANSFER OF PRIMACY

STATEMENT OF INTENT

The Event Management Team, comprising the Event Controller and Safety Officer as appointed by the organiser's for this event is responsible for the safe running and management of this event and the crowd.

Transfer of Primacy

An Garda Síochána is responsible for the monitoring and addressing of Public Order issues as well as the implementation, in the agreed manner, of the Traffic Management Plan. Both parties will work together to ensure a safe and enjoyable event.

In the event of the implementation of the Emergency Plan, as agreed between the Event Management Team and An Garda Síochána, and in consultation with the attending medical services, An Garda Síochána and the Emergency Services will take primacy at the event and the Event management Team and its agents will put themselves at the disposal of the Emergency Services to implement the Emergency Plan.

In the event of the Emergency Plan being successfully implemented and the event subsequently being safe to re-proceed, An Garda Síochána and the Emergency Services shall return primacy and overall control of the event to the Event Management Team.

All such decisions and changes of primacy shall be recorded, in writing, and signed off on by all parties in the Event Log.

Facility is also in place for partial transfer of primacy in the event that the Emergency Plan is to be implemented in a specific, localised area where it is not affecting the event in its entirety at that time. Again, this will be detailed and recorded in writing in the Event Log, as outlined above.

SIGNED:

DATED:

Aí Garda Síochána / Fire Officer

Event Controller

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Procedure for CPPP The Whale Street on the narrow streets of Galway.

Having seen The Whale Street to mitigate the risk to the public this procedure is to be applied to move the float safely through the streets of Galway.

There is a team of five who will be holding a rope forming the shape of a V and stretching this rope to the Preestablished measurements to create a space wide enough for the float plus 1.2 metres between the float and the nearest member of audience.

This team will move ahead of the float establish the route, will then be followed by Stewarts who will reinforce the route.

Alongside the float will be 8 people each side holding a rope and creating a cordon around the performance, this cordon is to be kept in place from the beginning of the parade till it reaches the end at the Spanish Arch.

Prior to the event areas that would be concerned to event control will have markings placed on the road to assist Security and area managers to maximise the available space for the float to pass safely.

In consideration of the size of the The Whale Street and it's ability to expand and height, Event control area manager who will be ahead of the parade will be monitoring the wind speed with a handheld anemometer. The company has advised that the The Whale Street can operate in gusts up to 60 KM per hour.

Street furniture

There is a number of premises along the route with street furniture that need to be removed prior to the event. Contact from the event organisers and licensing authority in writing plus a site visit is required to ensure route is clear.

CCTV Plan

Event control has 8 wireless cameras that will be fitted along the route. These cameras have the ability to rotate and maximise the viewing area. The location of each camera will be determined by what's available to mount them to and plan will be formed when cameras are deployed.

Hostile vehicle mitigation

Map to be DRAWN

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DRAWING

route plan



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Company Risk Assessment

To be furnished

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SCHEDULE

The following is a schedule for CPPP The Whale Street Spectacle 2026

16th July. company assembly at Nimmo's Pier.

17th July. Volunteers and Security briefing with rehearsal @7.30pm

Volunteers and Security get into there assigned positions @ 9.00pm

Company makes their way from Nimmo's Pier under escort along Merchants

Road

to reach the pedestrian street and complete their preparations at the public toilets.

Performance 1 begins @ 9.30pm

Performance ends at Spanish Arch @10.45pm

The Whale Street returns to Nimmo's Pier.

18th July. Volunteers and security returns for briefing @ 4.30pm

Company leaves Nimmo's and return to Eyre Square via Merchants Road for 5.50pm to complete set up.

Performance 2 begins @9.30pm.

Spectacle ends at Spanish Arch @10.45pm

Company returns to Nimmo's Pier for derig.

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Draft GIAF Medical Plan (Incorporating Draft Emergency Plan)

1.0 DRAFT GIAF MEDICAL PLAN (Incorporating Draft Emergency Plan)

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Section 1

1.1 Introduction and Objectives

Galway International Arts Festival are organizing a street spectacle throughout the streets of Galway on 17th and 18th of July 2026. It is a large Whale structure. beginning at Eyre Square on to Shop street ,Maingaurd Street, Bridge Street,Dominick Street ,and concluding at the Spanish Arch.

Event Control Centre is located in The Galway Advertiser's offices Eyre Square.

The main objective of the GIAF and indeed the main objective of the Medical Plan will be to:

- Ensure that required Medical Treatment is available and administered to persons attending the event as required

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- Reduce as far as practicable or eliminate the impact on HSE services. Reducing the impact on the existing services will help to ensure that the normal levels of care can be provided to the general community in Galway City and its surrounds.

The objectives will be achieved by the coordination of the various Agencies and Organizations involved and will include the HSE, Fire Brigade, Civil Defense, Galway City Council and

Aí Garda Síochána the coordination will be achieved by meetings and various communications between all parties.

The scope of this plan relates only to GIAF street spectacle on 17th and 18th of July 2026.

1.2 References

- Code of Practice for Safety at Outdoor Pop Concerts and other Outdoor Musical Events

Section 2

2.1 Event Medical Management Structure / Details

Event Medical Coordinator	Brendan Qualter
Medical Service Provider	Civil Defense

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2.2 Medical Coordinator.

The Medical Coordinator is Brendan Qualter.

There will be a number of venues required for coordination of Medical Arrangements they are as follows:

2.3 Location of Event Medical Facilities.

Venue	Description	Numbers of Personnel and level of Qualification (EFR, EMT Paramedic etc)
Medical Control	Civil Defense @ the Fire station	Event control steward with radio also in attendance
Medical Centre		
Location(s) Ambulance(s)	Eyre Square following parade and one parked at Mill street and one parked at corner of Lombard St.	3 EMT's
Roaming First Aiders	Dispersed through the route.	6 EFR

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2.4 Control of Noise

We have considered the effect of noise when selecting the location of the Medical facilities and do not envisage that the noise levels to be intrusive.

2.5 Duties and Responsibilities

Medical Coordinator Duties

- Act as the single point of contact for the Medical Plan.
- Participate in Medical/Event planning meetings and sign off on Event Medical Plan and any drills and rehearsals
- Ensure all medical personnel are briefed on the event medical plan
- To provide overall coordination of the various medical services providing cover at the event.
- To act as point of contact for the HSE Environmental Health Service
- To liaise with the Event Organisers, Event Controller, Event Safety Officer, the National Ambulance Service Control, the Voluntary Emergency Services, An Garda Síochána, the HSE Environmental Health Service and any other relevant agencies/personnel.
- To allocate medical resources effectively prior to and during the event and to keep a register of all those who have roles in the event medical plan.
- To ensure that all relevant process and contact details are in place for effective and efficient communications.
- To ensure that the appropriate PPE has been provided.
- To establish and maintain links throughout the event as appropriate with the receiving hospitals and the HSE emergency services
- To ensure that the Patient Care Report forms are completed for all medical assists and provide a summary to the event organizers post event
- To attend end of event debrief
- Ensure command structure is established.

2.5.1 Deputy Medical Coordinator Duties

The Deputy Medical Coordinator duties will be as follows:

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- To assume the duties of the Event Medical Coordinator should the Event Medical Coordinator not be in a position to carry out his duties
- To actively support the Event Medical Coordinator in his role

2.6 Event Control/Operational Timing

The operational timings of Event Control and Medical Control will be as follows:

Date	Operational Timing	Comments
17/7/26, 18/7/26	8.30pm til 11pm	

2.7 Medical / First Aid Procedures

The Civil Defense will provide first aid cover to the event.

First Aid Posts Procedures

All event medical personnel will operate within their scope of practice, as defined by Irish Medical Council (doctors), An Bord Altranais (nurses) and Pre-Hospital Emergency Care Council (Advanced Paramedics, Paramedics, EMT's and Emergency First Responders). The Event Medical Coordinator retains overall clinical responsibility for patients who seek medical/first-aid assistance at the event. As such, all patient treatment / transfer requests will be notified to the Event Medical Coordinator for approval.

The following procedures apply to first aid posts:

- Crews manning a First Aid Post must report to Medical Control once post is operational.
- The post should be manned by agreed complement at all times.

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- Procedure for treatment of patients in the First Aid Post should follow the Patient Management Procedures detailed in this document
- Where there is doubt about a patient's condition a member of the Post crew must contact medical control/ doctor for their advice and direction on the situation.
- With all suspected medical conditions, a doctor must be consulted.
- No medication of any type is to be administered to a patient at a First Aid Post without the direction of a Practitioner.
- All relevant patient and treatment details must be recorded on the relevant form and returned to Medical Control at the end of each day.
- On completion of the day's duty the person in charge of the post must ensure that:
 - a) The post is secure.
 - b) All relevant forms are handed in to the Medical Coordinator.
 - c) All communications equipment is handed back to Medical Control.

First Aid Posts will only be closed down on the direction of Medical Control

Provide first aid staff & ambulances as agreed within their patient care protocols

- Operate within their level of competence
- Be identifiable in high visibility/reflective uniform
- Be 18 years and over.
- Report any concerns in respect to audience safety to the Event Safety Officer via their senior officer/Medical Control.
- Be present on site at the agreed start time and remain on site until such time as medical/First Aid operations are stood down
- To transport patients both on and off site as directed
- Perform their duties in accordance with their level of training.
- Complete all documentation required in relation to patient care.
- Will direct all media enquiries to the relevant PRO/Media personnel.

The following indicates the patient management procedure to be adhered to during the event:

Level 1

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Patients who present to the onsite First Aid Posts will be initially assessed by the first aid staff at this facility. Following this quick assessment and noting of the suspected condition the patient will either be administered first aid treatment and discharged from the facility or referred to the next available level of care available. At this stage the patient's details must be recorded on the approved PHECC (Pre Hospital Emergency Care Council) patient report form. If patient is encountered in the field away from a First Aid Post and further treatment is required the patient must be transported to the nearest First Aid Post. If the patient is unable to undertake this journey due to the nature of their condition then further assistance must be requested via medical control.

Level 2

Patients at First Aid Posts who require further assistance outside the scope of first aid should be referred to the Emergency Medical Technicians (EMTs) at the post who will assess the patient further and administer treatment as required prior to discharge. Emergency Medical Technicians may also encounter patients in the field and will adhere to the procedures laid down in level one for the management of patients.

Level 3

Patients requiring further assessment and/or treatment off site will be referred to an appropriate medical facility. Contact must be made via the Control with the proposed receiving hospital given the details of the intended transfer. No patient should be sent to a medical facility off site without first going through Medical Control.

Documentation

All medical and first aid providers will provide a report for each patient. This will be completed on the PHECC (Pre Hospital Emergency Care Council) patient report form; the form should be filled in as applicable with all available details recorded. The patient form is transported with the patient to be issued

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to HSE staff at the applicable Hospital should the patient require additional care. The copy of the form (there is one copy in addition to the original) is held by the first aid organization acting on behalf of the event organiser.

The PHECC (Pre Hospital Emergency Care Council) patient report form will be completed as appropriate to each case for all enquires to First Aid Posts.

Patient Discharge

- Patients may be discharged back to the site if their complaint is minor (e.g. Simple wound, uncomplicated headache, sore throat).
- Patients who require further assessment, (e.g. ECG) will be referred to the hospital in addition to those clearly requiring admission.
- The PHECC (Pre Hospital Emergency Care Council) patient report form incorporates a discharge section and will be used in all cases.

2.8 Referrals to Hospital

All patients who require further treatment at hospital should be sent to the Emergency Department, University Hospital Galway with the completed PHECC (Pre Hospital Emergency Care Council) patient report form;

No patient will be sent to hospital from the event without having been assessed first except in exceptional circumstances, by an authorised professional. The Emergency Department of the receiving hospital and NAS National Emergency Operations Centre will be notified of all such transfers

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Proximity to Definitive Care

Hospital	Road Transit Time	Turnaround Time
UHG	5 minutes	Discretion of Hospital

Section 3

3.1 Event Medical Communications

Event medical radio communications will be managed by Event Medical Co-ordinator and Event Control based at Event Control Office. Event Medical communications shall also have direct radio contact with the following persons:

- Event Controller
- An Garda Síochána (Senior Guard on duty)
- Safety Officer
- Chief Steward

Communications will be also be available via landline and mobile phones; additional capacity may be provided by the network providers with designated key mobile telephone numbers to be notified to the mobile network providers to ensure coverage is prioritized where they are used.

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Calls will be handled in a number of ways depending on the type and what is required.

Medical control: where all communications will be handled for movement of ambulances and personnel, handling of incidents, and all medical issues.

Calls for assistance may be received in a number of ways

- By telephone (landline)
- By mobile phone
- By radio
- Running call by medical personnel already close to the incident.
- From NAS National Emergency Operations Centre
- From Garda control

All information will be logged.

The following details to be confirmed:

- L Location Where exactly are you?
- I Incident What has happened?
- R Requirement What exactly do you need?
- A Acknowledge Were you heard?

All callers to clearly identify themselves.

All incoming incident calls will be prioritized should there be a large number of calls received at once. Medical control will prioritize according to the severity of injury, the appropriate level of response will then be sent to each incident, and calls will be dispatched via the medical control radio network.

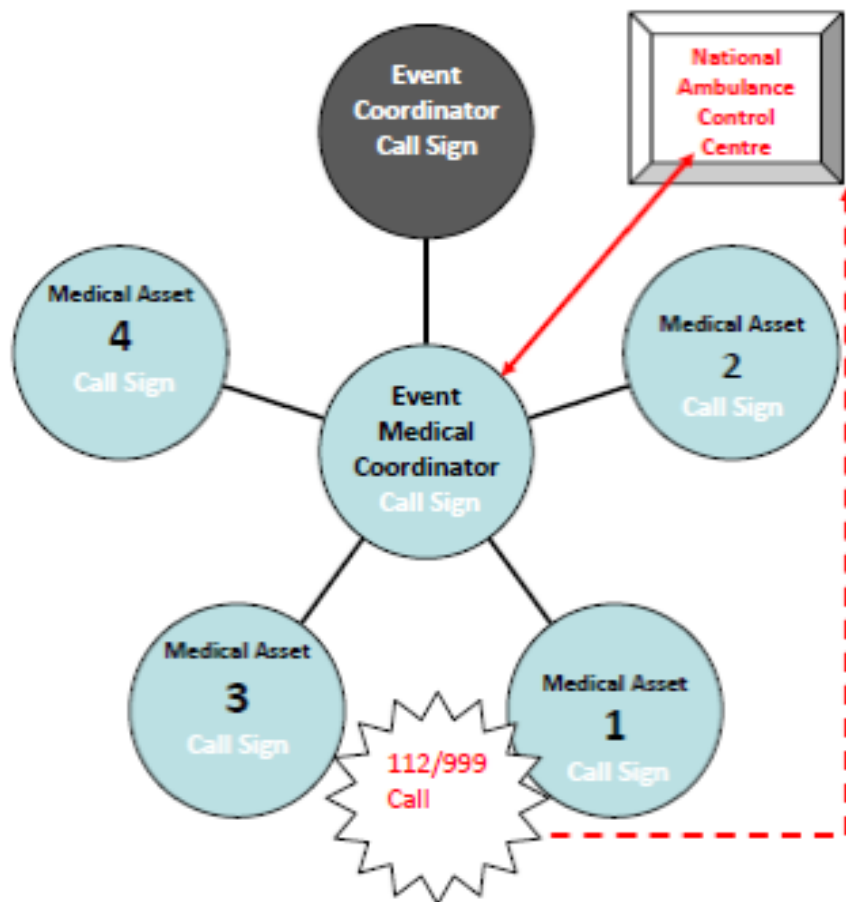
Call Signs

Call signs will be allocated at the commencement of each day.

A chronological login hard copy of all activity to medical control will be maintained.

The following is a sample of how medical communications would operate at the event.

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3.2 112/999 Calls from the Public at the Event.

In the case of 112/999 calls being made by a member of the public at the event site the following will apply:

- These calls will be taken by National Ambulance Service, as per normal procedures. All calls will receive an appropriate response and a HSE Emergency Ambulance will be dispatched to the scene, where appropriate. NAS may contact the Event Medical Control on the dedicated number 087 7387333 to notify the Event Medical Coordinator of the call and/or to seek assistance from appropriate responders on duty at the event.

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- Event Control in conjunction with the Gardai and security/stewards will ensure that the relevant access route is kept clear in so far as possible for the approaching ambulance.

3.3 Contact names and numbers

Title	Contact Name/Number		Operational Timing
Event Co-ordinator	Adam Fitzsimons	087 9799214	Full Day
Event Medical Co-ordinator	Brendan Qualter	087 7387333	Full Day
Event Control	Frank Commins	087 6479231	Full Day

3.4 Signage

Civil Defense personnel will be clearly identifiable to the public

3.5 Distribution of the event Medical Plan

GIAF will circulate a copy of the medical plan to the

Medical Coordinator who will be responsible for further circulation to their relevant service providers including the Medical Agencies and any other persons deemed appropriate.

The HSE Emergency Management Office who will circulate it to the relevant HSE services.

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3.6 Sirens and lights

Sirens and lights will be used only as required under the direction of the Medical Coordinator, Medical Control will liaise with the Event Controller and Gardai to ensure that the required assistance is provided to ensure clear access and egress to and to from the scene. Adherence to 'The use of blue lights and sirens' legislation and the 'Road Traffic Act' will be complied with at all times

Section 4

Please refer to other relevant sections of the Event Plan for details of overall Event management and fire safety procedures

4.1 Ambulance Emergency Route

The emergency route is as indicated within the event traffic management plan, See maps

4.2 Procedures for Fire/Security Incidents

These are covered in main plan.

Section 5

5.1 Infection Prevention and Control

Standard precautions will apply in order to prevent infection cross between first aid/medical personnel and patients; this will include use of appropriate PPE.

5.2 Clinical Waste

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All clinical waste generated from first aid activities will be subject to appropriate storage and disposal. This will relate to sharps, dressings and personal protective equipment. The clinical waste will be securely disposed of by the provider of Medical services of the Civil Defense.

5.3 Environmental Health

The organizers will ensure that the appropriate arrangements are in place at the event to ensure the health of performers, patrons and the general public.

This will include the following:

- Appropriate sanitary arrangements will be provided in all areas in accordance with Code of Practice for Safety at Outdoor Pop Concerts and other Outdoor Musical Events. (Appropriate maintenance and servicing will be maintained)
- Water
- Appropriate collections of waste generated from the event.

A full schedule of casual traders particularly food vendors will be provided to the HSE EHO prior to the event.

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Section 6

The HSE Emergency Management office will forward a copy of the final draft of this plan to the HSE National Ambulance Service for comment & observations. The Final Medical plan will be forwarded to NAS National Emergency Operations Centre in advance of the event

Section 7 Major Emergency Plan

SERIOUS INCIDENT

A serious incident may be declared by the Event Medical Coordinator when the resources available on-site via the event medical team are unable to deal with the severity or number of attendees requiring medical assistance. This may require assistance from the National Ambulance Service in terms of personnel, ambulances or other equipment. The decision to call upon these resources will be made by the Event Medical Coordinator via the NAS National Emergency Operations Centre OR the NAS Liaison Officer if in attendance.

The Request will be made using using the ETHANE format:

E - the Exact location

T - the Type of incident

H - the Hazards present and potential

A - the Access to the location of the incident and egress route

N - the Number and severity of casualties

E - the Emergency services present and required at the scene

7.1 Major Emergency

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Definition of a Major Emergency

“A Major Emergency is any event which, usually with little or no warning, causes or threatens to cause death or injury, serious disruption of essential services, or damage to property or the environment or infrastructure beyond the normal capabilities of the principal emergency services in the area in which the event occurs and requires the activation of specific additional procedures and the mobilization of additional resources to ensure an effective, coordinated response.”(A Framework for Major Emergency Management 2006)

A Major Emergency can only be declared by an authorized officer of one of the Principal Response Agencies (PRA's)

In the event of a major emergency, the Controller of Operations of the PRA's Event Controller will proceed immediately to Event Control (If appropriate) . This area may be designated the On-Site Coordination Centre.

7.1 Emergency Procedures

ACTION UPON DISCOVERY OF FIRE

Outdoor

- Person discovering the Fire to immediately inform Event Controller.
- The Event Controller will contact the emergency services required directly. They will state the location and source (if known) of the fire.
- The Event Controller will contact the Medical Coordinator
- Stewarding/Fire Personnel to attack the fire if it is safe to do so if appropriate equipment is available.
- In the case of a serious fire a decision will be made to evacuate the area as required.

Indoor (Venues)

- Raise alarm both verbally and by nearest MCP (Manual Call Point/Break Glass)
- Fight fire only if safe to do so

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- Evacuate the building using the nearest emergency route
- Proceed to assembly point
- Wait at assembly point until directed otherwise by an authorized person only (Authorized person will be your fire warden)

EMERGENCY/SECURITY PROCEDURES IN THE EVENT OF BOMB THREAT/SUSPECT PACKAGE

- The Event Controller to be immediately informed of all details in the event of bomb threat/suspect package.
- The situation to be assessed by the Event Controller and senior Garda Officer present based on the information received in order to determine the veracity of the threat.
- If a decision is made to carry out a search this will be carried out using the most competent persons available. If a package is found the area is to be secured and the Event Controller is to be informed.
- The Senior Garda officer present will take the decision to evacuate the area is applicable.

PROCEDURES IN THE EVENT OF CROWD DISTURBANCE/OVERCROWDING

- The senior steward on duty to inform Event Control to enable additional resources to be provided if required.
- The GARDAI in association with the Safety Officer will initiate procedures to resolve the situation. This may include:
 - Cessation of Music or activities either immediately or in a phased controlled way.
 - Structured announcements to the crowd advising as to procedures, i.e. directions to move away etc.

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EVACUATION PROCEDURES

If the evacuation is due to serious fire, bomb, bomb threat or other emergency the following are the procedures. This relates mainly to outdoor events. This will be jointly organized and managed by the Gardai, Safety Officer and Senior Stewards present. Other principal response agencies will be incorporated as applicable.

- Production personnel/persons co-ordinating the activities to be advised so that activities can be suspended.
- Appropriate communications to be directed to the public by PA systems or at local areas dependent on scale of the evacuation.
- Stewards to assist the Gardai in manning the evacuation and ensuring that evacuation routes are kept clear in so far as possible.
- All persons engaged in the management of the drill procedure to act in a calm organized manner.
- In the event of a major incident the Gardai will assume ultimate control.
- Consideration will be made to arranging temporary large scale assembly areas, these areas will where possible offer basic levels of welfare.

Assembly Points/Areas

Designation of assembly points where evacuees can safely congregate in the event of an emergency will be developed.

Larger assembly areas/zones will be established for in the event of a large scale evacuation in terms of outdoor activities. An example of this could be the evacuation of numerous persons from a particular area of the town.

The availability of potable water/shelter and welfare facilities are important in cases where large groupings of people are held in an area for a period of time. It is also possible that evacuees would return to their cars in this scenario although this may lead to congestion of approach roads which in turn could delay

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emergency services coming from authorities outside the town. Where the potential for this occurs it may be more prudent to restrict persons returning to their vehicles for a period of time

Park and ride facilities could be used to transfer persons with reduced personal mobility from areas of risk.

In all cases of evacuation the utmost priority will be afforded to ensuring that assembly points and areas offer the required protection and welfare to the persons affected

Section 8 (Miscellaneous)

8.1 Crowd Densities

As stated in the overall Event Draft Plan, the capacities for particular areas will be determined at 30,000. Crowd capacities will not be exceeded; this will be managed by stewarding, personnel counter systems and barriers. Active monitoring will be provided by Safety officer and Security personnel during performances.

8.2 Unaccompanied Persons/Lost Children

Please liaise with member of Aí Garda Siochana in the event of. The review stand will act as central meeting point for lost children.

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Section 9 Risk Assessment for River.

The parade is crossing the river on two location at O Brian's bridge and Wolf tone bridge.

O Brian's Bridge will have six persons supervising the bridge to encourage people to not sit on the wall,

I will also have Claddagh Watch personnel with throw lines monitoring the river.

It is worth noting that the tides for these parade timing is for tides to be going out or gone out and the time of the year water levels would be also low.

I will be made contact with Shane Coogan, Water safety officer for Galway City and County.

This is the proposal at the time of writing this draft but we will have to take into consideration weather conditions in the lead up to the event that with a spell of poor weather water level could be higher then seasonal expected and assessment will be made on dealing with safety concerns on days before the event.

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Traffic Management plan

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